

TECHTALKS PRESENTS

WHAT'S NEXT AFTER GRADUATION?

The complete roadmap to landing your first tech job

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Career Coach • Recruitment & Employability Strategist

60-90 min interactive workshop

How We'll Use This Room

An interactive career conversation — not a one-way lecture

Ask anytime

Open your mic or use the chat. No question is too basic.

Share honestly

Confusion after graduation is normal — we learn faster when we say it out loud.

Practice live

We will rewrite CV bullets, create LinkedIn headlines, and map next steps.

Leave with action

You should know what to do tomorrow — not just feel inspired today.

Not a résumé. A story.

A career journey built through exploration, youth support, and recruitment insight

6,000
+

young people supported

600+

students mentored

2

sides of hiring

I work at the intersection of education and employment.

Career readiness • employability programs • AI workshops • bootcamps • coaching • recruitment support

Today you'll hear both perspectives: the candidate side and the recruiter side.

I've been in your shoes

Lost, unsure, and trying to choose a path during uncertainty

1 COVID + crisis

I entered university during a confusing time and didn't have clear guidance.

2 Wrong-fit path

I started in Economics, then slowly realized it didn't fully resonate with me.

3 Exploration

Workshops, volunteering, programs, and LinkedIn helped me meet people and learn.

4 First opportunities

Internships and programs showed me my real strengths: people, growth, and youth empowerment.

Your career is not discovered in one perfect decision — it is built through exploration.

Three Questions We'll Answer

The same questions every fresh graduate asks

How do I get my first job?

Applications, proof, networking, and interview readiness.

How do I stand out?

CV, LinkedIn, GitHub, projects, and personal brand.

What should I focus on in tech?

Career lanes, market signals, AI, FDE, cybersecurity, and practical skills.

Graduation Is Not a Hiring Strategy

A degree opens the door — evidence gets you invited in

WHAT KEEPS YOU STUCK

- Apply “hoping” instead of applying strategically
- Have experience but present it weakly
- Use one CV for every role
- Leave LinkedIn empty or generic
- Wait until graduation to start building proof

WHAT MOVES YOU FORWARD

- Target roles and build proof
- Translate duties into outcomes
- Match CV language to the job
- Use LinkedIn as a mini portfolio
- Start building projects and network early

You Don't Have to Fit One Box

Tech careers are no longer only “sit and code all day”



Forward Deployed Engineer (FDE)

FDE = Forward Deployed Engineer. Think of an FDE as someone who is part consultant + part engineer + part AI expert.

Instead of only writing code, they: Meet with clients. Understand the client's business problems. Build AI solutions or AI workflows. Help companies actually deploy AI successfully.

Bridge between business needs and technical execution.

ACTIVITY 1

Know Yourself Sprint

Before choosing a role, collect clues about yourself

Things I enjoy doing

Things people ask me for help with

Things I learn quickly

Things that make me lose track of time

Problems I naturally notice

Work environments I prefer

3 minutes: write one answer for each prompt. Then circle the repeated patterns.

Pick a Target Before Writing Anything

Your CV can't be strong if it's trying to speak to everyone

1 Target roles

Choose 2-3 maximum: e.g.,
Frontend Developer, QA Engineer,
Data Analyst.

2 Target skills

Pick the top 5 skills you want
recruiters to remember.

3 Target proof

Projects, GitHub, internship,
volunteering, or coursework that
proves the skills.

Activity: Write your target role + five skills in the chat.

Sample Tech Roadmaps

Different paths, same rule: build proof

FRONTEND

HTML
↓
CSS
↓
JavaScript
↓
React
↓
Next.js
↓
TypeScript
↓
Projects

BACKEND

Java
↓
Spring
↓
REST APIs
↓
SQL
↓
Docker
↓
AWS
↓
Projects

AI / FDE

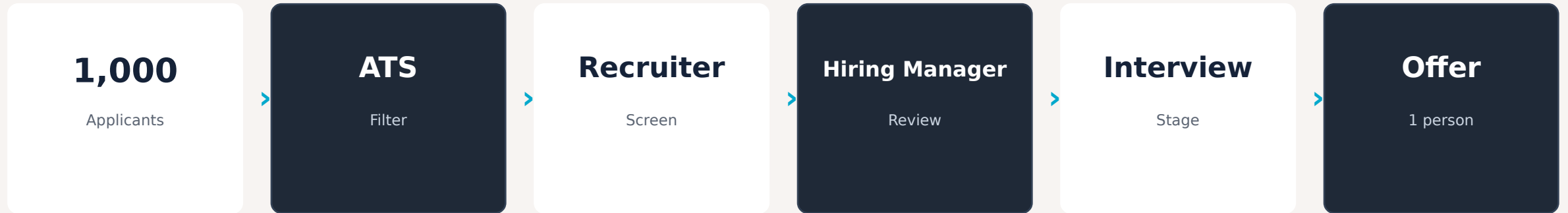
Python
↓
LLMs
↓
RAG
↓
LangChain
↓
Business Problems
↓
AI Workflows
↓
Projects

CYBERSECURITY

Networking
↓
Linux
↓
SIEM
↓
Threats
↓
Labs
↓
CTFs
↓
Projects

The Hidden Funnel

Every application has to survive multiple filters



A generic CV can be rejected before a human ever understands your potential.

Your CV Is an Argument

Not a biography. Not a list of duties. A case for why you're worth interviewing.

YOU

Education
Skills
Projects
Personality
Results

EMPLOYER

Problems
Deadlines
Users
Revenue
Quality

VALUE

Proof that your skills solve
their needs

Formula: I help [who] by using [skills] to achieve [result].

The 1-Page Tech CV Architecture

What recruiters should see in seconds

Header

Name • target title • phone • email • LinkedIn • GitHub • portfolio

Professional Summary

Role target + stack + proof + value

Skills

Grouped technical skills + supported soft skills

Experience

Internships, volunteering, club work, freelancing

Projects

2-4 strong projects with stack, links, and impact

Education & Training

Degree, relevant coursework, certifications

The Top Third Decides the First Impression

Header + headline + summary + skills should tell a clear story

LEA HADDAD

Junior Full Stack Developer | React • Node.js • PostgreSQL • REST APIs

Beirut, Lebanon | +961 70 000 000 | lea.haddad@email.com | linkedin.com/in/leahaddad | github.com/leahaddad | portfolio.dev

SUMMARY

Junior Full Stack Developer with hands-on experience building responsive web applications using React, Node.js, Express, and PostgreSQL. Skilled in REST API integration, Git workflows, and clean UI implementation. Seeking to contribute to an agile engineering team while continuing to build scalable production-ready applications.

SKILLS

JavaScript • TypeScript • React • Next.js • Node.js • Express • PostgreSQL • MongoDB • REST APIs • Git/GitHub • Tailwind CSS • Agile/Scrum

Stop Writing “Looking for an Opportunity”

Write a summary that sounds like a tech candidate

WEAK

“Looking for an opportunity to grow and learn in a great company.”

Why it fails: no role, no stack, no proof, no value.

STRONG

“Junior Full Stack Developer with experience building responsive web apps using React, Node.js, PostgreSQL and REST APIs.”

Why it works: role + stack + proof + direction.

Tech Profile Examples You Can Adapt

Use role + stack + proof + direction

Frontend Developer

Frontend Developer skilled in React, Next.js, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS, with experience building responsive dashboards and portfolio projects.

AI Engineer

AI-focused developer with experience using Python, LLM APIs, LangChain, and RAG workflows to build practical AI assistants and automation tools.

Forward Deployed Engineer

FDE-oriented engineer combining technical problem solving, client discovery, and AI workflow design to help teams turn business problems into deployable solutions.

Cybersecurity Analyst

Cybersecurity student with hands-on labs in Linux, networking, threat analysis, and SIEM tools, seeking a junior SOC or security internship role.

Organize Skills the Way Recruiters Think

Grouped, specific, and scannable — not a random list

Programming

JavaScript • TypeScript • Python • Java

Frameworks

React • Next.js • Node.js • Spring Boot

Databases

PostgreSQL • MySQL • MongoDB

Tools

Git • GitHub • Jira • Postman • Figma

AI / Data

LLMs • RAG • Pandas • Power BI

Soft Skills

Communication • Ownership • Teamwork

Tip: prioritize the skills repeated in the job description.

Projects Are Your Experience Before Experience

For fresh graduates, projects are often the strongest proof

- 1 What problem did you solve?
- 2 Which tools did you use?
- 3 What did you personally build?
- 4 Where is the code or demo?
- 5 What was the result or learning?

Example Project Bullet

Built a full-stack event discovery platform using React, Express, MongoDB, and JWT to help students find and book community events; deployed live demo and documented setup in GitHub README.

Project > certificate when it proves the skill.

GitHub: The Section Most Workshops Skip

For tech profiles, GitHub is often the second CV

Pin your best repositories

Curate — don't dump every class assignment.

Write a README that sells

Purpose, stack, screenshots, live demo, setup.

Use clean commits

Commit messages show how you work.

Deploy one project live

A working link beats a wall of code.

Profile README

Short bio + stack + links + pinned work.

Sample Junior Tech CV

A fake version you can show safely in the session

LEA HADDAD

Junior Full Stack Developer

Beirut, Lebanon | lea.haddad@email.com | linkedin.com/in/leahaddad | github.com/leahaddad | portfolio.dev

SUMMARY

Junior developer with hands-on experience building responsive web applications using React, Node.js, Express and PostgreSQL. Skilled in REST APIs, Git workflows and UI implementation.

SKILLS

JavaScript • TypeScript • React • Node.js • Express • PostgreSQL • MongoDB • REST APIs • Git/GitHub • Tailwind CSS • Jira

EXPERIENCE

TechBridge Labs — Web Development Intern | Jul 2025-Aug 2025

- Built core pages for an event platform using React and Tailwind CSS.
- Integrated REST APIs and collaborated through GitHub pull requests.
- Improved mobile responsiveness across key user flows.

PROJECTS

AI Tools Directory — React, TypeScript, Express, MongoDB | Live Demo | GitHub

- Developed a full-stack platform for browsing categorized AI tools with admin management and responsive UI.
- Implemented clean reusable components and documented the setup in the README.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science — Lebanese University | Expected 2026

Turn Duties Into Accomplishments

Recruiters want results, not laundry lists

Weak

Responsible for building a website.



Built and deployed a responsive club website using React and Tailwind CSS, helping 70+ students access events, resources, and updates.

Weak

Worked on backend APIs.



Developed REST API endpoints in Express.js and MongoDB to support user authentication, content management, and admin workflows.

Weak

Used AI tools.



Applied AI tools to debug errors, generate test cases, and improve development productivity while validating all outputs manually.

Formula: Action + What + How + Result / Proof

Common CV Mistakes That Quietly Eliminate You

Small issues can hide strong potential

1. Generic CV / not targeted

2. Too many paragraphs

3. No keywords from job description

4. No GitHub or portfolio links

5. Spelling and grammar errors

6. Duties without impact

7. Too many fonts and colors

8. Missing dates or unclear timeline

9. Certificates without projects

10. File name: "CV-final-final2.pdf"

LinkedIn Is Your Second CV

A mini career website recruiters can find before you apply

Profile photo

Headline

About

Experience

Featured

Skills

Education

Recommendations

Activity

Goal: make your profile discoverable, credible, and connected to your target role.

Don't Let LinkedIn Choose Your Identity

Your headline should be searched, understood, and remembered

AVOID

Student at X University
Fresh Graduate
Looking for Opportunities

USE

Target Role | Stack / Skills | Proof Direction

Junior Backend Engineer | Java • Spring Boot • SQL • REST APIs
AI Engineer | Python • LLMs • RAG • LangChain
Frontend Developer | React • Next.js • TypeScript

About Section: Short, Human, Targeted

Make it sound like you — but still searchable

Simple Formula

- Who you are
- What you build / do
- Tools and skills
- Proof: projects, internships, volunteering
- What you're looking for next

Mini Example

I'm a junior developer focused on building user-friendly web applications with React, Node.js, and REST APIs.

Through university projects and internships, I've worked on responsive interfaces, API integration, Git workflows, and team collaboration.

I'm currently seeking junior full-stack or frontend opportunities where I can keep learning while contributing to real products.

Featured Section: Make Proof Easy to Verify

Recruiters should not have to search for your work

Portfolio

Best projects, contact, CV,
links

GitHub

Pinned repositories +
README

Project Demo

Live app or walkthrough
video

Certificate

Relevant proof only

Post

What you built + what you
learned

Ask yourself: what can I show, not just claim?

Use LinkedIn Weekly, Not Once a Year

Visibility grows through small repeated actions

Comment

Leave thoughtful comments on posts in your field

Connect

Add 5–10 relevant people weekly with a message

Share

Post one project update or lesson learned

Search

Use keywords to find roles, companies, and alumni

Follow

Recruiters, engineering leaders, communities, companies

Networking Is Not Asking for a Job

It is building relationships before you need something

WHO TO TALK TO

- Alumni
- Junior developers
- Recruiters
- Community organizers
- Mentors
- Open-source contributors

MESSAGE TEMPLATE

Hi [Name],

I came across your profile while exploring [target role]. I'm currently building my skills in [skill/stack] and would love to connect and learn from your journey.

Thank you!

20 Great Applications Beat 1,000 Generic Ones

Tailor, track, follow up

1,000 GENERIC

- Same CV every time
- No company research
- No keywords
- No follow-up
- Low reply rate

20 STRATEGIC

- CV matched to role
- Company researched
- Project proof highlighted
- Short tailored note
- Real conversations

Track: Role | Company | Date | Status | Link | Contact | Notes

Use AI Throughout Your Job Search

Don't let AI replace your story — let it sharpen it

CV review

Ask for ATS gaps and clearer bullets

Job description scanner

Extract must-have skills and keywords

Mock interview

Practice STAR answers and technical explanations

README generator

Turn projects into recruiter-friendly documentation

LinkedIn support

Improve headline, About, and posts

Learning roadmap

Create a 30-day plan for your target role

Every Interview Needs Two Tools

STAR for evidence + Present/Past/Future for your intro

STAR METHOD

S Situation

T Task

A Action

R Result

TELL ME ABOUT YOURSELF

Present Where you are now

Past What prepared you

Future What you want next

“Tell Me About Yourself” — Tech Version

Clear, short, and connected to the role

Present

I’m a computer science graduate focused on full-stack web development, mainly using React, Node.js, and PostgreSQL.

Past

Through internships and university projects, I built responsive web apps, integrated APIs, and collaborated through GitHub workflows.

Future

I’m now looking for a junior developer role where I can contribute to real products, keep improving my engineering habits, and grow with a strong team.

Keep it under 90 seconds.

Questions That Make You Sound Serious

Interviews are two-way conversations

What does success look like in the first 3-6 months?

What skills should I strengthen before joining this role?

How does the team review code and support junior developers?

What does onboarding usually look like?

What are the biggest challenges the team is solving this quarter?

The 30-Day Challenge

One focus per week — small action, real momentum

Week 1

Career Direction

Pick target role + roadmap + 5 skills

Week 2

CV

Rewrite summary, headline, skills, projects

Week 3

LinkedIn

Update headline, About, Featured, activity

Week 4

Projects & GitHub

Polish one project end-to-end and deploy it

Small consistent action beats a perfect plan you never start.

BEYOND GRADUATION STARTS TODAY

Your CV gets you noticed. Your LinkedIn builds trust. Your projects prove your skills. Your network creates opportunities.

Today's homework

Tailor one CV • update one LinkedIn headline • polish one project or GitHub README

THANK YOU

Farah Kerbaj | Let's connect on LinkedIn